

Pranav Pativada

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EDUCATION

Australian National University (ANU)

Feb. 2021 – Jun. 2025

ANU, Canberra

- Bachelor of Philosophy (PhB) (Science) – Honours. Majoring in **Computer Science** and **Machine Learning**.
- **6.72/7 GPA. 86% Weighted Average Mark (High Distinction Average)**.
- Honours in **numerical optimisation** with **Oxford Visual Geometry Group**. Achieved **88 HD**.
- Courses in **compilers, operating systems, algorithms, networks** and **formal verification**.

PUBLICATIONS/AWARDS

- **Best Project @ Alignment Research Bootcamp Oxford 2025:** Refusal and Incapability as directions in open-source models
- **Best Paper Runner Up @ DICTA 2023:** Contrastive-Aware ViT for Weakly Supervised Semantic Segmentation.
- **Runner Up @ 2024 BlueDot Impact AI Alignment Projects:** Exploring The Intersection of Interpretability and Optimisation.
- **Acknowledgement in RSS 2025 Submission:** Interior Point Differential Dynamic Programming.

EXPERIENCE

Member of Technical Staff

Oct. 2025 – now

Artificial Intelligence Underwriting Company, San Francisco

- **Frontier red teaming, model evaluations research, and benchmarks.** Developed infrastructure to run **autonomous multi-modal evaluations**.
- 15M seed backed by Nat Friedman, Anthropic and Emergence. First engineering hire.

Entrepreneur in Residence

Jul. 2025 – Oct. 2025

Entrepreneur First, San Francisco

- Entrepreneur First is Europe's premier incubator that invests in individuals to build startups from scratch.
- Worked on **compliance evaluations** and built low latency asynchronous **voice agents**.

Alignment Researcher

Mar. 2025 – Jul.2025

ANU, Canberra

- Researching **information-theoretic evaluations** for frontier models under a grant from **UK AISI**.

Contractor

Feb. 2025

METR, Remote

- Baselineing **SWE** and **MLE** tasks for **model evaluations**.

Researcher

Jan. 2025

OAI SI, University of Oxford

- Researched **mechanistic interpretability** and **reinforcement learning** under the Oxford AI Safety Initiative.
- **Steered** open-source models to intervene with incapability, an extension to the **refusal steering work**. This won best project.

Honours Researcher

August. 2024 – Jul. 2025

ANU, Canberra

- Researching and developing **machine learning optimisers** as part of my honours through ANU and **Oxford Visual Geometry Group**.
- Implemented a **hybrid second-order optimiser** to detect flat and saddle regions.

Software Engineer Intern

Nov. 2023 – Feb. 2024

IMC Trading, Sydney

- Implemented a **scalable** and **efficient data streaming system** for services to access recent historic trading parameters using **Kafka**.
- Implemented a **shareable LRU cache** with **configurable eviction** and **down sampling** for each IMC client.

Machine Learning Researcher

Nov. 2022 – Nov. 2023

CSIRO Data61, Canberra

- Implemented a novel **contrastive learning** algorithm to improve initial **class-activation maps** for baseline **Vision Transformer** models.
- This resulted in a publication and a runner up award at DICTA 2023.

SKILLS

- **Languages** Python (PyTorch), Java (Kafka, Guava, Dagger), C, JavaScript (Node, React, Prisma)
- **Tools** Git, Docker, LaTeX, Bash